

Coping Skills Toolbox

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

A coping skills toolbox is a personalized collection of strategies you can use when feeling stressed, anxious, or overwhelmed. Check the skills you have used or want to try, and add your own.

Physical Coping Skills

- Exercise (walking, running, stretching)
- Deep breathing exercises
- Progressive muscle relaxation
- Going for a walk outdoors
- Yoga or gentle movement
- Splashing cold water on face
- _____

Emotional Coping Skills

- Journaling thoughts and feelings
- Art, drawing, or creative expression
- Listening to music
- Allowing yourself to cry
- Talking to someone you trust
- Practicing self-compassion
- _____

Social Coping Skills

- Calling or texting a friend
- Attending a support group
- Volunteering in the community
- Spending time with a pet
- Participating in a community activity
- _____

Cognitive Coping Skills

- Thought challenging / reframing
- Mindfulness meditation
- Grounding exercises (see below)
- Positive affirmations
- Reading a book
- Puzzles or brain games
- _____

5-4-3-2-1 Grounding Exercise

5	things you can SEE	
4	things you can HEAR	
3	things you can TOUCH	
2	things you can SMELL	
1	thing you can TASTE	

My Top 5 Coping Skills

Write your five most effective coping strategies below. Keep this list visible and accessible.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____